# SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

**7 July 2022 · Shift 1**

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

## General English 23 questions

**Q.1**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. The playground was way "large then I had" imagined, and in cleaning it, my back began to ache.

**(A)** larger than I had
**(B)** No substitution required
**(C)** largest to what I have
**(D)** large then I have

**Q.2**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To foot the bill

**(A)** To reveal a secret
**(B)** To be friendly
**(C)** To hold grudges
**(D)** To make payment

**Q.3**

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. "Shall you pass" me that pasta bowl?

**(A)** Shall pass you
**(B)** Can you pass
**(C)** Could passing you
**(D)** No improvement required

**Q.4**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. He had begun to dig / diligent along the / low tideline and had / captured two clams.

**(A)** captured two clams
**(B)** low tideline and had
**(C)** diligent along the
**(D)** He had begun to dig

**Q.5**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I _____ your remaining project if you get groceries for me from the market.

**(A)** would do
**(B)** will do
**(C)** will have done
**(D)** would have done

**Q.6**

Select the correctly spelt word.

**(A)** Magestic
**(B)** Flexibal
**(C)** Stringent
**(D)** Faltoring

**Q.7**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Which _____ should I take to reach the railway station?

**(A)** root
**(B)** route
**(C)** rote
**(D)** riot

**Q.8**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Writing books about how to _____ on the internet seems like a great idea.

**(A)** make a promise
**(B)** make a fortune
**(C)** make a habit
**(D)** make a list

**Q.9**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I can't control my _____ these days because I got selected for a job.

**(A)** casualness
**(B)** nepotism
**(C)** pollution
**(D)** excitement

**Q.10**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The Lebanese army raided the boat and _____ dozens of water bottles, tuna cans, loaves of bread, boxes of Picon cheese and life jackets.

**(A)** discovered
**(B)** learnt
**(C)** created
**(D)** invented

**Q.11**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. My elder brother is so innocent that winning an argument against him is like "shooting fish in a barrel."

**(A)** Indulge in an illegal activity
**(B)** Exceptionally easy to do
**(C)** Asking for charity
**(D)** Making someone uneasy

**Q.12**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Sacred

**(A)** Consecrated
**(B)** Submissive
**(C)** Passionate
**(D)** Adamant

**Q.13**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The study of different skin diseases

**(A)** Neurology
**(B)** Dermatology
**(C)** Psychology
**(D)** Radiology

**Q.15**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who is hostile and violent

**(A)** Idle
**(B)** Aggressive
**(C)** Legendary
**(D)** Agreeable

**Q.16**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Plausible

**(A)** irresistible
**(B)** Irrational
**(C)** Untenable
**(D)** Credible

**Q.18**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Hilarious

**(A)** Ridiculous
**(B)** Pretentious
**(C)** Usual
**(D)** Humourless

**Q.19**

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. A significant number of students volunteers each year for environmental projects.

**(A)** volunteers each year for
**(B)** No error
**(C)** A significant number of students
**(D)** environmental projects

**Q.20**

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them contains an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. Time and technology are two important factor that change substances into resources.

**(A)** Time and technology
**(B)** resources
**(C)** factor that
**(D)** two important

**Q.21**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Can you (1) _____ a deaf woman writing stories about a war? Well, Laura Redden Searing did this. Moreover, she went to foreign countries to write stories. She was very ill when she was 11 years old. Because of this, she lost her (2) _____. She went to the Missouri School for the Deaf. Laura was 19 years old when she went to work for a newspaper. She wrote about people, places and art. In 1859, most women were just wives and (3) _____. They did not work outside the home; otherwise, their husbands would be angry. Due to this feeling, Laura used a (4) _____ name when she wrote her stories. She called herself Howard Glyndon. She thought that unless she used a masculine name, people would be (5) _____ since they did not think that women should write for newspapers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

**(A)** malign
**(B)** create
**(C)** conjure
**(D)** imagine

**Q.22**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Can you (1) _____ a deaf woman writing stories about a war? Well, Laura Redden Searing did this. Moreover, she went to foreign countries to write stories. She was very ill when she was 11 years old. Because of this, she lost her (2) _____. She went to the Missouri School for the Deaf. Laura was 19 years old when she went to work for a newspaper. She wrote about people, places and art. In 1859, most women were just wives and (3) _____. They did not work outside the home; otherwise, their husbands would be angry. Due to this feeling, Laura used a (4) _____ name when she wrote her stories. She called herself Howard Glyndon. She thought that unless she used a masculine name, people would be (5) _____ since they did not think that women should write for newspapers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

**(A)** hearing
**(B)** suffering
**(C)** enduring
**(D)** inspiring

**Q.23**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Can you (1) _____ a deaf woman writing stories about a war? Well, Laura Redden Searing did this. Moreover, she went to foreign countries to write stories. She was very ill when she was 11 years old. Because of this, she lost her (2) _____. She went to the Missouri School for the Deaf. Laura was 19 years old when she went to work for a newspaper. She wrote about people, places and art. In 1859, most women were just wives and (3) _____. They did not work outside the home; otherwise, their husbands would be angry. Due to this feeling, Laura used a (4) _____ name when she wrote her stories. She called herself Howard Glyndon. She thought that unless she used a masculine name, people would be (5) _____ since they did not think that women should write for newspapers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

**(A)** artists
**(B)** writers
**(C)** mothers
**(D)** teachers

**Q.24**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Can you (1) _____ a deaf woman writing stories about a war? Well, Laura Redden Searing did this. Moreover, she went to foreign countries to write stories. She was very ill when she was 11 years old. Because of this, she lost her (2) _____. She went to the Missouri School for the Deaf. Laura was 19 years old when she went to work for a newspaper. She wrote about people, places and art. In 1859, most women were just wives and (3) _____. They did not work outside the home; otherwise, their husbands would be angry. Due to this feeling, Laura used a (4) _____ name when she wrote her stories. She called herself Howard Glyndon. She thought that unless she used a masculine name, people would be (5) _____ since they did not think that women should write for newspapers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

**(A)** woman's
**(B)** children's
**(C)** adult's
**(D)** man's

**Q.25**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Can you (1) _____ a deaf woman writing stories about a war? Well, Laura Redden Searing did this. Moreover, she went to foreign countries to write stories. She was very ill when she was 11 years old. Because of this, she lost her (2) _____. She went to the Missouri School for the Deaf. Laura was 19 years old when she went to work for a newspaper. She wrote about people, places and art. In 1859, most women were just wives and (3) _____. They did not work outside the home; otherwise, their husbands would be angry. Due to this feeling, Laura used a (4) _____ name when she wrote her stories. She called herself Howard Glyndon. She thought that unless she used a masculine name, people would be (5) _____ since they did not think that women should write for newspapers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

**(A)** infantile
**(B)** versatile
**(C)** hostile
**(D)** infertile

## General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

**Q.1**

After interchanging the given two signs, what will be the value of the following expression? × and ÷; 20 + 5 ÷ 6 × 2 – 5

**(A)** 30
**(B)** 35
**(C)** 25
**(D)** 40

**Q.2**

The IQ of 7 boys B1, B2, B3, B4, B5, B6 and B7 is tested and the values are compared. B2 has a higher IQ than B6. B5 has the third lowest IQ. B4 has a higher IQ than 6 boys. B3 has an IQ less than B2. B1 has a higher IQ than B2. B7 has the least IQ. Who has the second highest IQ?

**(A)** B2
**(B)** B7
**(C)** B1
**(D)** B3

**Q.3**

Identify the number that does NOT belong to the following series. 49, 98, 196, 394, 784, 1568

**(A)** 196
**(B)** 784
**(C)** 394
**(D)** 1568

**Q.4**

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No T is G. Some M are T. Conclusions: I. No G is T. II. All M are G.

**(A)** Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
**(B)** Both conclusions I and II follow.
**(C)** Only conclusion I follows.
**(D)** Only conclusion II follows.

**Q.8**

Select the option in which the numbers shares the same relationship as that shared by the numbers in the given set. (132, 186, 240) (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed)

**(A)** (124, 158, 202)
**(B)** (148, 202, 256)
**(C)** (118, 172, 198)
**(D)** (142, 176, 194)

**Q.9**

After interchanging which two signs will the value of the given expression be '35'? 13 + 91 – 3 ÷ 529 × 23

**(A)** + and –
**(B)** × and ÷
**(C)** × and +
**(D)** – and ÷

**Q.10**

8 persons D, E, F, G, H, I, J and K are sitting around a square table, facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). Four persons are sitting at the corners and four persons are sitting at the middle of the sides of the square table. D is sitting at one side and opposite to K. G is sitting at a corner and to the immediate right of D. D is the immediate neighbour of E and G. I is not the immediate neighbour of H. F is sitting at one side and opposite to H. Who is sitting just diagonally opposite to I?

**(A)** K
**(B)** H
**(C)** D
**(D)** E

**Q.11**

6 persons A, B, C, D, E and F are sitting around a rectangular table, facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). One person is sitting on each of the smaller sides. Two persons are sitting on each of the bigger sides. No person is sitting at the corners. C and F are sitting on the same side. B is sitting opposite to A. F is the immediate neighbour of B. A is sitting second to the left of D. Counting towards the left of D, how many persons are sitting between A and D?

**(A)** Two
**(B)** Three
**(C)** One
**(D)** Zero

**Q.12**

Select the option that is related to the sixth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the third number is related to the fourth number. 34 : 12 :: 28 : 16 :: ? : 15

**(A)** 26
**(B)** 24
**(C)** 32
**(D)** 35

**Q.13**

Identify the number that does NOT belong to the following series. 14, 21, 63, 378, 3402

**(A)** 3402
**(B)** 14
**(C)** 21
**(D)** 378

**Q.16**

In a certain code language, 'POKER' is written as 'IHDXK' and 'FANDS' is written as 'YTGWL'. How will 'AQBCG' be written in that code language?

**(A)** TJVVG
**(B)** TKUVZ
**(C)** TJVUZ
**(D)** TJUVZ

**Q.17**

Select the option in which the pair of letter-clusters share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of letter-clusters. ROP : NMP :: ?

**(A)** TIN : LGV
**(B)** MUG : ESK
**(C)** CRB : DPA
**(D)** LAN : LXJ

**Q.18**

In a certain code language 'who are you' is written as 'Sue Re Nik', 'they is you' is written as 'Pi Re Sor', and 'they are dangerous' is written as 'Pi Nik Zhi'. What is the code for 'dangerous' in that code language?

**(A)** Sue
**(B)** Nik
**(C)** Pi
**(D)** Zhi

**Q.19**

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. Pitch : Cricket :: Court : Badminton :: Ring : ?

**(A)** Football
**(B)** Boxing
**(C)** Hockey
**(D)** Rugby

**Q.21**

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All X are B. II. No C is X. Conclusions: I. Some B are not C. II. All C are B. III. Some X are C.

**(A)** Only conclusion I follows
**(B)** None of the conclusion follow
**(C)** Only conclusions I and II follow
**(D)** Only conclusions II and III follow

**Q.22**

In a certain code language, ‘random boys talk’ is written as ‘8 3 P’, ‘talk too much girls’ is written as ‘3 4 2 6’. How will ‘talk’ be written in that language?

**(A)** 3
**(B)** P
**(C)** 2
**(D)** 8

**Q.23**
Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. BOND, FKRZ, JGVV, NCZR, ?

**(A)** RYDN
**(B)** RYDM
**(C)** RXDN
**(D)** RYCN

**Q.24**
In a certain code language, 'DELHI' is written as 'CDKGH', 'NERVOUS' is written as 'MDQUNTR' and 'SURE' is written as 'RTQD'. What is the code for the word 'MILLION' in that code language?

**(A)** HHSKNMK
**(B)** LHKKHNM
**(C)** SKHHALO
**(D)** LADAKHN

**Q.25**
Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PV : MQ :: FB : ?

**(A)** CX
**(B)** DW
**(C)** DX
**(D)** CW

## General Awareness 24 questions

**Q.1**
Hariprasad Chaurasia is a _____ player.

**(A)** flute
**(B)** mandolin
**(C)** shehnai
**(D)** guitar

**Q.2**
In which year did Bhagat Singh and BK Dutt throw a bomb in the Central Legislative Assembly?

**(A)** 1928
**(B)** 1929
**(C)** 1930
**(D)** 1931

**Q.3**
As per the 2011 census of India, population density of which of the following states was less than 100 people per square kilometre?

**(A)** Himachal Pradesh
**(B)** Rajasthan
**(C)** Sikkim
**(D)** Tripura

**Q.4**
If ‘u’ is the object-distance, ‘v’ is the image-distance and ‘f’ is the focal length of a spherical mirror then which of the following is a correct expression for the mirror formula?

**(A)** $1/v + 1/u = -1/f$
**(B)** $1/v - 1/u = 1/f$
**(C)** $1/v + 1/u = 1/f$
**(D)** $1/v - 1/u = -1/f$

**Q.5**
'Red Light On Gaadi Off' campaign was launched by the government of _____.

**(A)** Uttar Pradesh
**(B)** Haryana
**(C)** Delhi
**(D)** Punjab

**Q.6**
Who among the following has been ranked as the richest person in the world, as per the Forbes’ Real-Time Billionaires list 2022?

**(A)** Elon Musk
**(B)** Jeff Bezos
**(C)** Bernard Arnault
**(D)** Warren Buffet

**Q.7**
Which of the following organisms is responsible for sleeping sickness?

**(A)** Algae
**(B)** Protozoa
**(C)** Bacteria
**(D)** Viruses

**Q.8**
In which state of India, is the Chapchar Kut festival celebrated?

**(A)** Jharkhand
**(B)** Goa
**(C)** Mizoram
**(D)** Kerala

**Q.9**
Rainfall is measured by an instrument called the _____.

**(A)** rain gauge
**(B)** barometer
**(C)** pirani gauge
**(D)** altimeter

**Q.10**
The temples of Khajuraho are a magnificent example of the _____ of the temple.

**(A)** Vesara style
**(B)** Nagara style
**(C)** Eastern style
**(D)** Dravidian style

**Q.11**
'Bhavai' is the traditional theatre form of which Indian state?

**(A)** Gujarat
**(B)** Nagaland
**(C)** Tamil Nadu
**(D)** Karnataka

**Q.12**
As per the Union Budget 2022-23, how many new jobs are to be created under the productivity linked incentive scheme in 14 sectors?

**(A)** 60 lakhs
**(B)** 80 lakhs
**(C)** 40 lakhs
**(D)** 20 lakhs

**Q.13**
Manuscripts were usually written on:

**(A)** marbles
**(B)** palm leaf
**(C)** tulsi leaves
**(D)** iron

**Q.14**
Gatka, a traditional fighting style of the Nihang Sikh warriors, used both for self-defence as well as a sport, has originated from which of the following states of India?

**(A)** Gujarat
**(B)** Rajasthan
**(C)** Bihar
**(D)** Punjab

**Q.16**
'Total Recall : My Unbelievably True Life Story' is an autobiography of:

**(A)** Chris Gayle
**(B)** Eddie Huang
**(C)** IK Gujral
**(D)** Arnold Schwarzenegger

**Q.17**
Where are villi present in the human alimentary canal?

**(A)** Pancreas
**(B)** Oesophagus
**(C)** Stomach
**(D)** Small intestine

**Q.18**
Rajaraja I, the most powerful Chola ruler, became king in _____ C.E.

**(A)** 985
**(B)** 970
**(C)** 977
**(D)** 995

**Q.19**
Guru Bipin Singh was known for which classical dance form?

**(A)** Manipuri
**(B)** Kathak
**(C)** Bihu
**(D)** Kathakali

**Q.20**
The premier iron ore exporting port of India is situated in _____.

**(A)** Uttar Pradesh
**(B)** Goa
**(C)** Maharashtra
**(D)** Gujarat

**Q.21**
Article 43B was inserted as a _____ in the Constitution of India.

**(A)** Constitutional body
**(B)** Fundamental duty
**(C)** Directive principle of state policy
**(D)** Fundamental right

**Q.22**
The Constitution of India states that 'no person shall be eligible for election as President of India unless he has completed the age of _____ years'.

**(A)** twenty-five
**(B)** forty
**(C)** thirty-five
**(D)** forty-five

**Q.23**
If a batsman hits a ball twice other than for the purpose of protecting his wicket or with consent from the opposition then:

**(A)** the batsman is given a warning
**(B)** the ball is declared dead
**(C)** he is out
**(D)** a bye of five runs is declared

**Q.24**
The Tendulkar Committee Report (2011-2012) was based on _____.

**(A)** population growth
**(B)** commerce
**(C)** poverty
**(D)** unemployment

**Q.25**
Which of the following pairs of name of battle and year is/are correctly matched? I. Battle of Buxar – 1764; II. Battle of Plassey – 1757

**(A)** Only I
**(B)** Both I and II
**(C)** Only II
**(D)** Neither I nor II

## Answer key

### General English

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(A)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.3 **(B)** | Q.4 **(C)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(C)** |
| Q.7 **(B)** | Q.8 **(B)** | Q.9 **(D)** | Q.10 **(A)** | Q.11 **(B)** | Q.12 **(A)** |
| Q.13 **(B)** | Q.15 **(B)** | Q.16 **(D)** | Q.18 **(D)** | Q.19 **(A)** | Q.20 **(C)** |
| Q.21 **(D)** | Q.22 **(A)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(D)** | Q.25 **(C)** | |

### General Intelligence and Reasoning

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(A)** | Q.2 **(C)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(C)** | Q.8 **(B)** | Q.9 **(B)** |
| Q.10 **(D)** | Q.11 **(C)** | Q.12 **(D)** | Q.13 **(A)** | Q.16 **(D)** | Q.17 **(B)** |
| Q.18 **(D)** | Q.19 **(B)** | Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(A)** | Q.23 **(A)** | Q.24 **(B)** |
| Q.25 **(D)** | | | | | |

### General Awareness

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(A)** | Q.2 **(B)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(C)** | Q.5 **(C)** | Q.6 **(A)** |
| Q.7 **(B)** | Q.8 **(C)** | Q.9 **(A)** | Q.10 **(B)** | Q.11 **(A)** | Q.12 **(A)** |
| Q.13 **(B)** | Q.14 **(D)** | Q.16 **(D)** | Q.17 **(D)** | Q.18 **(A)** | Q.19 **(A)** |
| Q.20 **(B)** | Q.21 **(C)** | Q.22 **(C)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(C)** | Q.25 **(B)** |

## Explanations

### General English

**Q.1 · Answer (A) larger than I had**

A comparison needs the comparative 'larger' and 'than', not 'then': 'The playground was way larger than I had imagined.'

**Q.2 · Answer (D) To make payment**

To 'foot the bill' is to pay for something, often on behalf of others.

**Q.3 · Answer (B) Can you pass**

'Shall' makes offers and suggestions with 'I' or 'we' ('Shall I pass it?'); a polite request to someone else takes 'can' or 'could': 'Can you pass me that pasta bowl?'

**Q.4 · Answer (C) diligent along the**

'Dig' is a verb, so it is described by an adverb: 'He had begun to dig diligently along the low tideline'.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) will do**

A likely condition in the present ('if you get') takes 'will' in the main clause, the first conditional: 'I will do your remaining project'. 'Would do' would need 'if you got'.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) Stringent**

'Stringent' is spelt correctly. The others should be 'majestic', 'flexible' and 'faltering'.

**Q.7 · Answer (B) route**

A 'route' is the way taken to reach a place. A 'root' is part of a plant, 'rote' is learning by repetition and a 'riot' is a violent disturbance.

**Q.8 · Answer (B) make a fortune**

To 'make a fortune' is to earn a great deal of money, which is why such books seem a great idea.

**Q.9 · Answer (D) excitement**

Being selected for a job makes one excited, so it is 'excitement' that is hard to control.

**Q.10 · Answer (A) discovered**

Raiding the boat, the army 'discovered' (found) what was on board. Things already there cannot be 'created' or 'invented', and one 'learns' facts, not objects.

**Q.11 · Answer (B) Exceptionally easy to do**

'Like shooting fish in a barrel' describes something ridiculously easy to do.

**Q.12 · Answer (A) Consecrated**

'Sacred' means holy, set apart for God: 'consecrated'. 'Submissive' means obedient and 'adamant' refusing to change one's mind.

**Q.13 · Answer (B) Dermatology**

Dermatology is the study of the skin and its diseases. Neurology deals with the nervous system and radiology with X-rays and other imaging.

**Q.15 · Answer (B) Aggressive**

An 'aggressive' person is hostile and ready to attack. 'Agreeable' is nearly its opposite, and 'idle' means lazy.

**Q.16 · Answer (D) Credible**

'Plausible' means seeming reasonable or believable: 'credible'. 'Untenable' and 'irrational' are nearly its opposite.

**Q.18 · Answer (D) Humourless**

'Hilarious' means extremely funny, so its opposite is 'humourless', lacking any humour.

**Q.19 · Answer (A) volunteers each year for**
'A number of' means 'many' and takes a plural verb: 'A significant number of students volunteer each year'. ('The number of' would take a singular one.)

**Q.20 · Answer (C) factor that**
'Two' needs a plural noun: 'two important factors that change substances into resources'.

**Q.21 · Answer (D) imagine**
'Can you imagine ...?' asks the reader to picture something surprising: a deaf woman reporting on a war.

**Q.22 · Answer (A) hearing**
The illness left her deaf, so she lost her 'hearing' and went on to a school for the deaf.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) mothers**
In 1859 most women were just 'wives and mothers'; the next sentence says they did not work outside the home.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) man's**
She wrote as 'Howard Glyndon', a 'man's name', which the last sentence calls 'a masculine name'.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) hostile**
People who thought women should not write for newspapers would be 'hostile', that is opposed and unfriendly, to her.

### General Intelligence and Reasoning

**Q.1 · Answer (A) 30**
After interchanging × and ÷: 20 + 5 × 6 ÷ 2 – 5 = 20 + 15 – 5 = 30.

**Q.2 · Answer (C) B1**
B4 is highest, B7 lowest and B5 fifth. B1 is above B2, which is above both B3 and B6, so B1 takes the second place and B2 the third.

**Q.3 · Answer (C) 394**
Each term is double the one before: 49, 98, 196, 392, 784, 1568. 394 should be 392.

**Q.4 · Answer (C) Only conclusion I follows.**
'No T is G' converts to 'No G is T', so I follows. The M that are T cannot be G, so 'All M are G' is false: only I follows.

**Q.8 · Answer (B) (148, 202, 256)**
The numbers rise by 54 each time: 132 + 54 = 186 and 186 + 54 = 240. Likewise 148 + 54 = 202 and 202 + 54 = 256.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) × and ÷**
Interchanging × and ÷: 13 + 91 – 3 × 529 ÷ 23 = 13 + 91 – 3 × 23 = 13 + 91 – 69 = 35.

**Q.10 · Answer (D) E**
D and K sit at the middles of opposite sides, with G at the corner on D's right and E at the corner on D's left; F and H take the other two middle seats and I and J the corners beside K. As I does not sit next to H, I is diagonally opposite E when H sits next to E, or opposite G when H sits next to G; G is not an option, so the answer is E.

**Q.11 · Answer (C) One**
A sits second to the left of D, so counting towards D's left exactly one person sits between them.

**Q.12 · Answer (D) 35**
The second number is the product of the first number's digits: 3 × 4 = 12 and 2 × 8 = 16. Likewise 3 × 5 = 15.

**Q.13 · Answer (A) 3402**
The multipliers double: 14 × 1.5 = 21, 21 × 3 = 63, 63 × 6 = 378, so the next term should be 378 × 12 = 4536, not 3402.

**Q.16 · Answer (D) TJUVZ**
Each letter moves 7 places back, wrapping round after A: P → I, O → H, K → D, E → X, R → K. So A → T, Q → J, B → U, C → V, G → Z: TJUVZ.

**Q.17 · Answer (B) MUG : ESK**
Each letter moves 2 places back and the cluster is reversed: ROP → PMN → NMP. Likewise MUG → KSE → ESK.

**Q.18 · Answer (D) Zhi**
'You' is common to the first two sentences (Re), 'they' to the last two (Pi) and 'are' to the first and last (Nik). So 'dangerous' is Zhi.

**Q.19 · Answer (B) Boxing**
Cricket is played on a pitch and badminton on a court; boxing is fought in a ring.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) Only conclusion I follows**
Every X is a B and no X is a C, so the B that are X are not C: I follows. Nothing says every C is a B, so II does not follow, and III contradicts 'No C is X'.

**Q.22 · Answer (A) 3**
'Talk' is the only word in both sentences and 3 the only code in both, so 'talk' is written as 3.

**Q.23 · Answer (A) RYDN**
The first letters move +4 (B, F, J, N, R), the second −4 (O, K, G, C, Y), the third +4 (N, R, V, Z, D) and the fourth −4 (D, Z, V, R, N), wrapping round the alphabet: RYDN.

**Q.24 · Answer (B) LHKKHNM**
Each letter is replaced by the one before it: DELHI → CDKGH and SURE → RTQD. So MILLION → LHKKHNM.

**Q.25 · Answer (D) CW**
P moves 3 places back to M and V 5 places back to Q. Likewise F → C and B → W, wrapping round after A: CW.

## General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (A) flute**
Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia plays the bansuri, the bamboo flute of Hindustani classical music.

**Q.2 · Answer (B) 1929**
Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt threw bombs in the Central Legislative Assembly in Delhi on 8 April 1929, in protest against the Public Safety Bill and the Trade Disputes Bill, and courted arrest.

**Q.3 · Answer (C) Sikkim**
The 2011 census put Sikkim's population density at 86 people per square kilometre. Himachal Pradesh had 123, Rajasthan about 200 and Tripura 350.

**Q.4 · Answer (C) 1/v + 1/u = 1/f**
For a spherical mirror the object distance u, image distance v and focal length f are related by 1/v + 1/u = 1/f. (For a lens it is 1/v − 1/u = 1/f.)

**Q.5 · Answer (C) Delhi**
The Delhi government launched 'Red Light On, Gaadi Off' in October 2020, asking drivers to switch off their engines at red lights to cut vehicle pollution.

**Q.6 · Answer (A) Elon Musk**
Forbes' 2022 World's Billionaires list (April 2022) ranked Elon Musk first, ahead of Jeff Bezos and Bernard Arnault, and he still topped its real-time list when the exam was held in July 2022.

**Q.7 · Answer (B) Protozoa**
Sleeping sickness (African trypanosomiasis) is caused by the protozoan Trypanosoma, spread by the bite of the tsetse fly.

**Q.8 · Answer (C) Mizoram**
Chapchar Kut is Mizoram's spring festival, held after the forest has been cleared for jhum (shifting) cultivation.

**Q.9 · Answer (A) rain gauge**
A rain gauge collects and measures rainfall. A barometer measures air pressure, an altimeter height, and a Pirani gauge very low gas pressures.

**Q.10 · Answer (B) Nagara style**
The Khajuraho temples, built under the Chandela rulers, are a classic example of the Nagara style of north India, with its curving towers (shikharas).

**Q.11 · Answer (A) Gujarat**
Bhavai is a folk theatre form of Gujarat (also performed in Rajasthan) that mixes dance, music and satire.

**Q.12 · Answer (A) 60 lakhs**
The Union Budget speech of 1 February 2022 said the PLI schemes in 14 sectors had the potential to create 60 lakh new jobs over the next five years.

**Q.13 · Answer (B) palm leaf**
Manuscripts in early India were usually written on palm leaves, or on the specially prepared bark of the birch tree.

**Q.14 · Answer (D) Punjab**
Gatka, the Sikh martial art of fighting with sticks and swords, comes from Punjab.

**Q.16 · Answer (D) Arnold Schwarzenegger**
'Total Recall: My Unbelievably True Life Story' (2012) is Arnold Schwarzenegger's autobiography. Chris Gayle's is 'Six Machine', Eddie Huang's 'Fresh Off the Boat' and I K Gujral's 'Matters of Discretion'.

**Q.17 · Answer (D) Small intestine**
The inner wall of the small intestine carries finger-like villi, which greatly increase the surface for absorbing digested food.

**Q.18 · Answer (A) 985**
Rajaraja I became king in 985 CE; he expanded the Chola kingdom and built the Brihadeshwara (Rajarajeshwara) temple at Thanjavur.

**Q.19 · Answer (A) Manipuri**
Guru Bipin Singh was a leading guru of Manipuri dance, which he researched, taught and helped spread.

**Q.20 · Answer (B) Goa**
Marmagao (Mormugao) in Goa is India's premier iron ore exporting port.

**Q.21 · Answer (C) Directive principle of state policy**
The 97th Amendment (2011) inserted Article 43B, on promoting co-operative societies, into Part IV, the Directive Principles of State Policy.

**Q.22 · Answer (C) thirty-five**
Under Article 58, a person must be a citizen of India and have completed 35 years of age to be eligible for election as President.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) he is out**

Under cricket's Laws, a batter who wilfully strikes the ball a second time, other than to guard the wicket, is out 'hit the ball twice'.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) poverty**

The expert group headed by Suresh Tendulkar reviewed how poverty is measured in India; the Planning Commission's poverty estimates for 2011-12 used its method.

**Q.25 · Answer (B) Both I and II**

The Battle of Plassey was fought in 1757 and the Battle of Buxar in 1764, so both pairs are correctly matched.

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